

gem-contribute

Building what you cannot find

Chris Hagmann · Blue Ridge Ruby 2026



I wanted to contribute back.

I never figured out where to start.

A small problem

I volunteered to help with **Hack Day** tomorrow.

I needed a list of **good Ruby projects** to point people at.

That list didn't exist.

So I built one.

What's out there

- [goodfirstissue.dev](#) · opt-in registry · sparse
- [goodfirstissues.com](#) · opt-in registry · sparse
- [github.com/topics/good-first-issue](#) · opt-in topic · sparse
- [forgoodfirstissue.github.com](#) · curated · narrow

These all rely on **maintainer opt-in** — and most maintainers never do.

The signal I needed was a different kind of opt-in: **mine**.

bundle fund for time

bundle fund reads your Gemfile.lock to answer
*"where should my **dollars** go?"*

gem-contribute reads the same file to answer
*"where should my **hours** go?"*

The insight was already on disk

```
$ bundle list | wc -l  
216
```

Your `Gemfile.lock` is already curated.

- ~216 maintainers you've **already bet on**
- The OSS code you have **the most context on**
- A vote of confidence with versions attached

Start *there*, not on GitHub.

So I built it

```
$ gem-contribute scan
Scanning Gemfile.lock (234 gems)...
234 gems · 230 on github.com · 1 on gitlab.com · 3 unknown source
```

Top contributable projects (by open `good first issue` count):

sorbet-runtime	50	github.com/sorbet/sorbet
rspec-openapi	5	github.com/exoego/rspec-openapi
gem-contribute	4	github.com/cdhagmann/gem-contribute
packwerk	4	github.com/Shopify/packwerk
rubocop	4	github.com/rubocop/rubocop
gitlab	3	github.com/NARKOZ/gitlab
pundit	2	github.com/varvet/pundit
...		

Fix it

```
$ gem-contribute fix rubocop/14102
Forking rubocop/rubocop → cdhagmann/rubocop...
Cloning into ~/code/oss/rubocop/rubocop...
Forked, cloned, and branched.
  path:      ~/code/oss/rubocop/rubocop
  branch:    gem-contribute/issue-14102
  upstream:  github.com/rubocop/rubocop
  fork:      github.com/cdhagmann/rubocop
```

```
Next: cd ~/code/oss/rubocop/rubocop && make your changes,
      then `gem-contribute submit`.
```


Submit it

```
$ gem-contribute submit  
Pushing gem-contribute/issue-14102 to origin...  
Opened browser to:  
https://github.com/rubocop/rubocop/compare/cdhagmann:gem-contribute/issue-14102  
?expand=1&title=Fix+%2314102%3A+Allow+Lint%2FVoid+...&body=Closes+%2314102.
```

Browser opens. PR is pre-filled. Review. Click **Create**.

The pattern generalizes

The things you depend on
are the things you should give back to.

Once you see that, you start noticing it everywhere.

Build for yourself first.

Help where you can.

The rest is bonus.

Thanks

```
gem install gem-contribute
```

cdhagmann.com/gem-contribute

Find me at **Hack Day** tomorrow — I'll watch it work on your laptop.

AI-assisted; ADRs explain why.